English Language

BankPrep AI | Banking Exam Preparation Study Material
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1. Parts of Speech

Noun: names a person, place, thing or idea.

Verb: expresses an action or state.

Adjective: describes a noun. Adverb: modifies a verb, adjective or another adverb.

Example: The quick runner runs quickly. 'Quick' is an adjective; 'quickly' is an adverb.

2. Subject-Verb Agreement

A singular subject usually takes a singular verb.

Incorrect: She go to work. Correct: She goes to work.

Question: They ___ cricket every Sunday. Answer: play.

3. Tenses

Simple present: I study every day.

Simple past: I studied yesterday.

Simple future: I will study tomorrow.

Question: Yesterday, he ___ to the bank. Answer: went.

4. Vocabulary

Synonym: a word with a similar meaning.

Antonym: a word with an opposite meaning.

Synonym of rapid: fast. Antonym of ancient: modern.

Question: Give an antonym for increase. Answer: decrease.

5. Sentence Correction

Incorrect: He do not know the answer.

Correct: He does not know the answer.

Question: Correct this sentence: She have two books. Answer: She has two books.

6. Reading Comprehension

Passage: Regular reading helps people learn new words, understand ideas and improve concentration.

Question: Name two benefits of regular reading. Answer: Learning new words and improving concentration.

7. What Changed in English Questions (2026)

Grammar rules are the same, but recent papers lean toward contextual questions rather than plain rule-recall. Practice questions in this file are original, written in the style of questions reported in recent exams. They are not actual exam questions.

SBI PO Prelims 2026 (1 and 2 August), as reported by candidates: a reading comprehension passage on a photography exhibition; synonym questions; about 5 to 6 para jumble questions; 2 to 3 word replacement; 3 to 4 double filler; 5 to 7 cloze test questions; and error detection.

SBI PO Mains 2026: reading comprehension, cloze test, para jumbles, column-based questions and error detection. The SBI PO Mains descriptive test (30 marks) is typed online and included tasks such as writing an email to HR declining a job offer.

SBI Clerk Prelims 2026 (26 and 27 September): reading comprehension, contextual vocabulary, core grammar, para jumbles, fillers and error detection, at an easy to moderate level.

IBPS PO Mains 2026: English carries only 20 marks for 40 questions, so spend minimal time per question there. The IBPS PO descriptive paper (25 marks) covers essay and comprehension.

8. Cloze Test

Passage: Digital banking has (1) ____ the way people manage money. Customers can now transfer funds, pay bills and open accounts without (2) ____ a branch. However, security remains a major (3) ____, and banks urge users to (4) ____ their passwords regularly.

Options: (1) (a) delayed (b) transformed (c) ignored (d) prevented. (2) (a) closing (b) selling (c) visiting (d) building. (3) (a) concern (b) benefit (c) habit (d) cause. (4) (a) forget (b) share (c) hide (d) change.

Answers: (1) transformed (b). (2) visiting (c). (3) concern (a). (4) change (d). Read the whole passage first, then fill the blanks that have the clearest clue.

9. Para Jumbles

Find the opening sentence first (it introduces the topic without a link word like 'this', 'as a result' or 'however'), then find the closing sentence, then pair the rest using pronouns and link words.

Q1. Arrange: A. As a result, many people now prefer online platforms. B. Earlier, customers had to stand in long queues at banks. C. The introduction of UPI changed this experience completely. D. Today, a payment takes only a few seconds. Answer: BCDA. B opens the topic, C introduces the change, D describes the present and A, beginning with 'as a result', concludes.

Q2. Arrange: A. The RBI raised the repo rate in October 2026. B. This move is expected to make loans costlier. C. Inflation had been rising through the year. D. The central bank said it wanted to keep prices stable. Answer: CADB. C gives the background, A states the action, D gives the reason and B states the effect.

10. Word Swap and Word Replacement

Word swap. Q1. In the sentence 'The bank has launched a new scheme to farmers support in rural areas', which two words should be interchanged to make it correct? Answer: 'farmers' and 'support'. Correct sentence: The bank has launched a new scheme to support farmers in rural areas.

Word replacement. Q2. 'The bank manager was very hostile to the customer's request and agreed immediately.' Choose the word that replaces 'hostile': (a) receptive (b) opposed (c) cruel (d) harsh. Answer: (a) receptive, because the manager agreed immediately.

11. Double Fillers

Q1. The new policy aims to ____ the burden on borrowers and ____ economic growth. (a) reduce, boost (b) increase, hurt (c) reduce, harm (d) raise, slow. Answer: (a). Reduce the burden and boost growth fit together logically.

12. Error Detection

Q1. Find the error: Neither of the two applicants were selected for the interview. Answer: 'were' should be 'was', because 'neither' takes a singular verb.

Q2. Find the error: The number of applicants have increased this year. Answer: 'have' should be 'has'. The subject is 'the number', which is singular.

13. Column-Based Questions

Match each beginning in Column I with the correct ending in Column II. Column I: (A) The RBI raised the repo rate. (B) Customers should complete KYC. (C) Banks must maintain CRR. (D) UPI payments have grown rapidly. Column II: (1) to curb inflation. (2) to keep their accounts active. (3) with the RBI as a cash reserve. (4) because they are fast and convenient.

Answer: A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4.

14. Reading Comprehension Practice

Passage: The annual photography exhibition in the city drew record crowds this year. Unlike earlier editions, which featured mostly landscapes, this year's exhibition focused on portraits of ordinary workers such as farmers, fishermen and street vendors. Organisers said they wanted visitors to notice people who are often overlooked. Several visitors said the portraits made them reflect on the effort behind everyday goods. Critics, however, argued that the exhibition would have been stronger if it had included captions explaining each worker's story.

Q1. What is the main theme of the passage? Answer: This year's exhibition shifted its focus to portraits of ordinary workers. Q2. What does 'overlooked' mean in the passage? Answer: Not noticed or ignored. Q3. What did critics suggest? Answer: Adding captions that explain each worker's story.

15. Contextual Vocabulary

Q1. Choose the meaning of 'scrutinise': examine closely. Q2. Choose the antonym of 'prudent': reckless. Contextual vocabulary means the correct word depends on the sentence, so always read the whole sentence before choosing.

16. Descriptive Writing (SBI PO Mains and IBPS PO Mains)

SBI PO Mains 2026 descriptive test: 3 tasks in 30 minutes for 30 marks, typed online, from email writing, situation analysis, and report writing or precis writing. IBPS PO Mains 2026 descriptive paper: 2 questions (essay and comprehension) in 30 minutes for 25 marks, typed in English.

Email structure: subject line, greeting, one-sentence purpose, two or three short body paragraphs, a polite closing and your name. Keep it formal, clear and under the word limit.

Situation analysis: state the problem in one line, give two or three options, choose one with a reason, and mention the risk and how you will manage it.

Essay: introduction with context, three to four body points with an example each, and a short conclusion. Banking-relevant topics: digital payments and financial inclusion; the effect of a repo rate rise on borrowers; the role of public sector banks in rural credit.

Precis: reduce a passage to about one third of its length, keep only the main idea and key points, write in your own words and use the third person.